DDD-T-001285(GSA-FSS)
February 8, 1967

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOWEL, DISH, COTTON CLOTH, LARGE SIZE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for large size (nominal size 36 by 36 inches) cotton cloth dish towels.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and grade. The towels covered by this specification shall be of one type and grade.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7210

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, D.C.).

Technical Manual of the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists.

(Copies may be obtained from Research Triangle Park, Box 886, Durham, N. C., 27702).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (6.2), a preproduction sample of the towel shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval.

3.2 Material and construction. The towels shall be made from plain woven cotton sheeting cloth. The cloth in the finished towels shall be washed and bleached and shall conform to the requirements shown in Table I when tested as specified in 4.4. The finished towels shall be white or off-white.

TABLE I - Physical requirements

Weight per square yard, ounces (minimum)	Yarns per inch (minimum)		Breaking strength, pounds (minimum)	
	Warp	Filling	Warp	Filling
3.7	48	44	38	33

3.3 Water absorption. When the finished towels are tested as specified in 4.4, the water shall rise at least 3 centimeters in 3-1/2 minutes in both warp and filling direction.

3.4 Hems or finished edges. The sides and ends of the towels shall have hems or finished edges. Fast selvage edges will be acceptable. Hems shall be of the flat or rolled type, stitched with two or more threads and have at least 7 stitches to the inch. Raw edges of flat hems shall be turned under. The stitching shall be stitch type 301 of Federal Standard No. 751. Finished edges may be either the overedge or overcast stitch type.

3.5 Dimensions. The finished towels shall measure 36 inches by 36 inches. The plus tolerance shall be 2 inches in either direction. A combined minus tolerance of 4 inches total will be allowed for both directions. (Note: For example, a 33 by 35 inch and 32 by 36 inch towel meets the minus tolerance requirements).

3.6 Fiber identification. Each towel shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.7 Workmanship. Towels shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQL's).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, inspection shall be made of the completed end item for conformance with all provisions of this specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The finished towel shall be examined for the defects listed in Table II. The inspection level shall be level I and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be 2.5 major and 6.5 total defects (major and minor combined) per 100 units. The sample unit for this examination shall be one towel. The lot size shall be the number of towels submitted for delivery at one time.

Table II - Classification of defects

Defects	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Cloth defects:		
Cut, hole or tear.	X	
Smash.	X	
Fine or light filling bar or light place.	X	
Broken or missing yarn:		
Two or more contiguous.	X	
Single.		X
Float and skip:		
Multiple 3/4 inch or more in combined directions.	X	
Multiple more than 1/4 inch but less than 3/4 inch in combined directions.		X
Single 1 inch or more in length.		X
Spot, stain, or streak over 1/8 inch in longest dimension clearly visible when viewed at a normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet).		X
Selvage (when applicable):		
Cut, torn, or broken.	X	
Curled, scalloped, or folded.		X
Rancid or other objectionable odor.	X	
Threads not adequately trimmed.		X
Unclean overall appearance.		X
Any weakening material defect which may develop into a hole or affect serviceability.	X	
Not finished as specified.		X
Workmanship defects:		
Any side or end unfinished.	X	
Needle chews - resulting in a weak place.		X
Loose stitch tension resulting in loosely secured seam.		X
Tight stitch tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to seam or stitching).		X

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The towels shall be examined for defects in dimensions. The inspection level shall be S-3. Sample unit and lot size shall be as specified in 4.3.1. Any dimension of the towel not in conformance with dimensions, including tolerances, specified herein shall be classified as a defect. The acceptable quality level shall be 1.5 defects per hundred units.

4.3.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in Section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with Table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table III - Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.

4.4 Testing of the end item. Tests shall be performed for the characteristics specified in table IV. The methods of testing specified in CCC-T-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in Table IV shall be followed. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one towel and the sample unit shall be the quantity of towels required to perform all the tests listed in Table IV. Unless otherwise specified, the physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes in the applicable test method. The sample size for each characteristic shall be in accordance with table V. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirements specified. The Government reserves the right to perform tests on towels as deemed necessary to determine compliance with the provisions of this specification.

Table IV - Test methods

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method
Weave	3.2	Visual 1/
Weight per square yard	Table I	5041
Yarns per inch	Table I	5050
Breaking strength	Table I	5100
Water absorption	3.3	4.5.1

1/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the results reported as "pass" or "fail."

Table V - Lot and sample size

Lot size	Sample size
Less than 800	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

4.5 Tests

4.5.1 Water absorption. Specimens of the cloth shall be cut from the finished towels, two in the warp direction and two in the filling direction, each specimen 2 cm. wide and not less than 15 cm. long. The specimens shall be suspended vertically so that approximately 3 cm. of the specimen is immersed in water. Small weights shall be fastened to the end of the specimen to keep it immersed through the test. The measurement of the rise of the water shall be made from the level of the liquid. The rate of absorbency shall be measured as the distance traversed by the liquid in the specimen during the 3-1/2 minute interval. The time shall be recorded from the instant the specimen end is in contact with the water. The rate of absorbency of the sample unit shall be the average of the results obtained from the specimens in each of the warp and filling directions. In order to facilitate the observation of the rise of the water, a dye solution of Acid Red 87 (approximating color index No. 45380 of the Technical Manual of the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists) may be added to the water before start of the test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each towel compactly folded to an approximate dimension of 9 inches by 11 inches shall be bundled in quantities as specified (6.2). Each bundle shall be packaged in a close-fitting polyethylene bag with the bag heat sealed. When specified (6.2) each bundle of towels shall be wrapped in paper conforming to UU-P-268, grade B secured with tape or adhesive or by two ties of cotton twine at each end of the bundle.

5.1.2 Level B. Each towel compactly folded to an approximate dimension of 9 inches by 11 inches shall be bundled in quantities of 12. Each bundle shall be packaged in a close-fitting polyethylene bag with the bag heat sealed.

5.1.3 Level C. The towels shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of towels in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-five unit packages of towels shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The towels shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard packaging (civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 respectively.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The towels covered by this specification are of the large size and are intended for use by Federal agencies of the Government.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) When preproduction sample is required (3.1).
(c) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Quantity of towels required in unit package, when level A packaging is specified (5.1.1).
(e) If bundle of towels is wrapped, when level A packaging is specified (5.1.1).
(f) Quantity of unit packages of towels required in shipping container, when level A packing is specified (5.2.1).

6.3 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring Officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.